

Hybrid and Work-From-Home (WFH) Policy

Document ID: HR-POL-WFH-010

Version: 4.2

Effective Date: August 1, 2024

Policy Owner: HR Operations & Facilities

Classification: Internal / Public (Employees)

1. Purpose and Objective

The Company embraces a flexible working culture that balances the benefits of in-person collaboration with the focused productivity of remote work. This policy outlines the guidelines, core hours, and financial support provided for hybrid and fully remote working arrangements.

2. Scope and Working Models

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees. Employment roles are classified into three distinct categories by the Department Head:

- Office-Essential:** Roles requiring 100% on-site presence (e.g., Facilities, physical security, hardware R&D).
- Hybrid (Default):** The standard model for 85% of the workforce. Employees are required to work from their designated base office **three (3) days per week** and may work remotely for the remaining two (2) days.
- Fully Remote:** Roles explicitly hired as 100% remote. These employees must reside within a 4-hour time zone difference of their core team.

3. Core Operating Hours and Availability

To ensure synchronous collaboration across time zones, the Company strictly enforces **Core Operating Hours from 10:00 AM to 03:00 PM local time**.

- All hybrid and remote employees must be online, available on the corporate messaging app, and available for virtual meetings during these core hours.
- Outside of core hours, employees maintain flexibility to manage their remaining daily hours (totaling 8 hours of active work) as they see fit.

4. WFH Ergonomics and Connectivity Allowances

The Company supports a healthy and productive remote work environment through the following subsidies:

4.1 One-Time Ergonomics Setup Allowance

- Newly hired Hybrid and Fully Remote employees are eligible for a one-time allowance of **USD 300** to purchase ergonomic home office equipment (e.g., supportive chair, standing desk converter, secondary lighting).
- **Claim Process:** Expenses must be submitted via Concur with itemized receipts within the first 60 days of employment.
- **Clawback:** If the employee resigns within 6 months of receiving this allowance, 100% of the amount will be deducted from their final settlement.

4.2 Monthly Connectivity Subsidy

- Hybrid and Fully Remote employees receive a flat, non-taxable (where local laws permit) stipend of **USD 50 per month** added to their payroll to subsidize high-speed home internet and personal mobile phone usage.
- Receipts are not required for this monthly stipend.

5. Security and Data Protection

When working remotely, employees are bound by the *Corporate IT Asset Management Policy* and must ensure:

- Company laptops are never connected to unsecured, public Wi-Fi networks (e.g., cafes, airports) without the corporate VPN actively engaged.
- Confidential company information is not visible to unauthorized household members or public bystanders (shoulder surfing).
- Printed physical documents containing sensitive data are properly shredded; no corporate data may be stored on personal, non-company external hard drives.

6. Temporary "Work From Anywhere" (WFA) Benefit

Hybrid and Office-Essential employees may request up to **20 working days per calendar year** to work from a remote location of their choice (domestic or international).

- WFA requires managerial approval at least 14 days in advance.

- Employees working internationally under the WFA benefit are entirely responsible for their own visa compliance and must not engage in local revenue-generating activities that could trigger corporate tax liabilities.

7. Points of Contact

- **Tier 1 (WFA Approvals & Roster):** Direct Line Manager.
- **Tier 2 (Ergonomics Claims):** expenses-support@company.com
- **Tier 3 (IT / VPN Connectivity Issues):** it-helpdesk@company.com

8. Amendment History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
2.0	Jun 01, 2021	HR Operations	Introduced the 3-2 Hybrid model post-pandemic.
3.0	Jan 15, 2023	David Kim	Formalized the USD 300 Ergonomics Setup Allowance and clawback rules.
4.0	Nov 01, 2023	Sarah Jenkins	Enforced VPN mandates for public Wi-Fi access.
4.2	Jul 15, 2024	David Kim	Added the 20-day "Work From Anywhere" (WFA) benefit.

9. Authorizations and Signatures

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Date: July 20, 2024

Reviewed By:

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Date: July 24, 2024

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Date: July 28, 2024